

Kristaps Grinbergs

kristaps.me

Web3 Blockchain & Full-Stack Developer | Product Creator | Conference Speaker

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I am an accomplished developer with expertise in Web3 blockchain technology, full-stack development, and mobile applications. I have a proven track record in building user-centric digital products that drive real value and revenue. As a co-founder of Qminder, contributed to scaling a global company with clients including Uber, Lyft, and The Olympic Games. I am passionate about open-source, inclusivity, and continuous learning. I enjoy orienteering, cycling, and gardening, and I have a special love for cats.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sep'23 - present

Developer Relations Engineer Lead

Flare Network, flare.network

Flare Network enables smart contracts and cross-chain interoperability for blockchains like Bitcoin and XRP, offering secure communication and decentralized finance (DeFi) capabilities.

I collaborate with stakeholders at C-level, developers, marketing and product design, organize events, and create technical documentation, including tools for interacting with Flare's products. I manage beta processes, test the system, and resolve technical issues. I contribute to marketing efforts by simplifying complex product concepts through blogs, videos, and conference presentations for wider audiences.

Technical integration engineer experience

- Active role at Flare's main product, FAssets, allowing non-smart contract chains such as Bitcoin to be used trustless on Flare. It is a cornerstone product and why this company was founded. I take care of technical beta processes. I onboard participants as FAssets system agents and test the system, managing it with 50+ community participants in closed beta and a couple of thousands in open beta.
- My experience in phased rollouts resulted in choosing it with closed beta participants in a controller environment, which was a huge success and learning for the whole team. The closed beta process consists of running game scenarios where participants earn points in exchange for FLR tokens. Flare gets valuable input about the FAssets system.
- I am actively testing the FAssets system, figuring out the algorithms that power the smart contracts, and using underlying tools. I fix tool bugs and constantly communicate with various stakeholders at the C-level, including developers, marketing, design, and ecosystem teams. I wrote FAssets guides on how participants can use the system, which includes multiple system roles. I maintain technical implementation and Docker containers on how to run services on their servers.
- I execute technical projects like providing collateral, managing internal system components, performing technical testing, and writing documentation. Now, I'm forming a new production team to observe how it is used and avoid any potential problems in the next stage for this product.

Business & stakeholders & cross-functional management

- I talked on stage at major industry events, organized successful gatherings, and worked with partners in Europe and Southeast Asia.
- I created an app showcasing our flagship product, which shows token prices on the chain and explains the math and algorithms behind it. I presented this app at several conferences.
- I write and maintain documentation for hackathons where Flare sponsors tracks. I wrote multiple guides on interacting with Flare's products for platforms like Hardhat and Foundry and on the Web.
- I take part in marketing content production for blogs, Twitter, videos, conferences, and hackathons to explain the FAssets product to wider audiences. My hard skill is to explain complicated products as straightforwardly as possible.

Jan'22 - Sep'23

Full Stack and Solidity Smart Contract Web3.0 developer

Salto X, saltox.co

A startup building stock option distribution tool on the blockchain that helped distributed teams incentivize employees around the globe.

I played an integral role in developing a blockchain token solution, contributing to creating Solidity smart contracts and a full-stack NextJS web application. I developed the smart contracts on the Polygon blockchain network, which calculates, stores, and executes all the legal frameworks built by the legal team. I created automatic tests using the Hardhat toolset. I used the OpenZeppelin Defender tool with a multi-signatory wallet powered by Gnosis for deployment. I made the client-facing integration with blockchain, which was built using the newest NextJS stack.

Aug'20 - Dec'21

Chief Technology Officer

Sharentic, Vaal

Co-founded two startups: **Sharentic**, an on-demand rental platform for items like Playstations, cleaning equipment, hiking gear, and construction tools, and **Vaal**, which focused on simplifying securitization for companies to attract financing based on asset quality. Both were discontinued due to economic challenges.

Sharentic: having raised 50K USD in angel investment, I built an iOS application and dashboard for managing the stock that generated revenue within a month. Scaling operations and marketing, Sharentic signed contracts with some large companies, such as the biggest pawn shop in Latvia, a company that IPOed the same year, a cleaning equipment company, and a hiking store that provided their stock. The company contributed a 1-2% increase in gross margins. Sharentic employed three co-founders and one developer.

Vaal: I built a prototype dashboard for companies to securitize their loan portfolios. I successfully validated the idea with Sun Finance Group (EUR 72.1 million net profit for 2023) and multiple of the biggest SE Asia payday loan companies. I explored blockchain technology to build such a product on the blockchain, making it more streamlined compared to existing solutions on the market.

Aug'11 - Apr'20

Technical Co-Founder

Qminder, qminder.com

Qminder is a global customer service and queue management platform trusted by clients like Uber, Lyft, and the Olympic Games. Its cloud-based system streamlines customer flow, providing real-time data and analytics to help businesses manage customer interactions effectively. Qminder processes millions of data points through the system monthly, with yearly recurring revenue of over 1 million USD.

- From a technical standpoint, I built all client-facing applications—iPhone, iPad, and Apple TV—using Objective-C and Swift. I regularly worked with the backend and front end, writing Java and JavaScript code.
- I led the development and execution of scalable processes and technical systems, ensuring the company could rapidly adapt to increased client demand and expansion. This involved optimizing workflows, improving cross-team collaboration, and introducing new technologies that reduced operational overhead and improved product quality, leading to faster feature delivery and better client satisfaction.
- I started the marketing, support, and sales teams when we established the company with my other two co-founders. I hired and trained responsible teams and managers to eventually take over these areas once the company grew in headcount. With the company's growth, I focused on the technical execution of all of Apple's ecosystem apps, including development, design, marketing, distribution, and working with client feedback. I frequently visited clients in the USA and across all of Europe.
- I onboarded one of the largest private companies then, Uber, connecting 600 of their client centers worldwide. I spent several months at Uber's HQ in San Francisco to facilitate onboarding. I fully integrated them onto the Qminder platform in less than six months.
- I know what it takes to build a company from nothing to 1 million in revenue. As a founder, I went through a lot—running out of money, raising funds, getting and losing clients, hiring more than 30 people and managing them, firing, failing many times, etc.

MENTORING / LECTURING EXPERIENCE

Jan'20 - present

Mentor

Riga TechGirls, rigatechgirls.com

Riga Tech Girls is Latvia's first community that helps women get into tech through workshops, mentorship, and networking. It is working to close the gender gap in the industry.

As a mentor and teacher at Riga Tech Girls, I help women enter the technology sector and get jobs. I taught them the hard skills of iOS development, blockchain, and operations behind running a business. I take pride in organizing workshops that empower women not only with valuable skills and knowledge, helping them thrive in the rapidly evolving tech landscape, but also supporting mental shifts and contributing to diversity and equal employment rights. I mentored 40+ women; many had a career leap to technology and successfully got employed in technology companies.

Sep'19 - Mar'20

Lead iOS Teaching Instructor

Lambda School (Bloom Institute of Technology), bloomtech.com

Bloom Institute of Technology, formerly Lambda School, is an online coding boot camp that trains students to become job-ready iOS developers through hands-on learning and career support.

I taught iOS development, including creating a curriculum and delivering lectures, guiding students through hands-on projects, and providing support to help them understand key concepts and build real-world applications. This iOS course produced job-market-ready graduates.

Sep'18 - Jan'22

Partner, Content Curator, Writer

Swift Weekly Brief, swiftweekly.github.io

A community-driven weekly newsletter about what's happening in the Swift open-source projects at Swift.org.

I curated the Swift Weekly Brief newsletter, which had over 10k subscribers. I wrote content about the news in Swift's open-source world and managed infrastructure by sending it out, hosting the website, and onboarding sponsors. I sent it bi-weekly, and the open rate was 60%+. The Apple team knew about this newsletter and often mentioned it during their organized WWDC conferences. When I attended the WWDC conference 2019 in California, I met up with some Apple representatives and discussed the benefits for developers.

EDUCATION

2004 - 2012

Bachelor and Master degrees in Computer Science, University of Latvia

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages

Fluent in English, Latvian, German